

>> **finding** a class and teacher

Now that you have enjoyed a taste of the benefits of dance in your own home, the chances are that you have become hooked enough to want to develop your new-found skills further. A dance class is a great way to learn more, improve your fitness levels, and have some fun.

It is important to find a class and an instructor that is right for you. The best way is by recommendation from a friend or colleague. You can also try your local gym or, if they don't run dance classes, your library or town hall can provide you with a list of places that do. Watch out, too, for the many community programs that exist to promote exercise. And, of course, the internet is also an excellent way to find classes in your area.

Checking what is out there

When choosing where to go for your class, it is worth making a list of points that are important to you. Depending on your priorities, such a list might look like the one shown here (see right).

Once you have found a class, you need to see if the instructor is right for you. Check also that he or she is certified to teach the class. There is a wide variety of dance instructors with an enormous range of certifications, so be cautious. Don't be too shy to inquire about the training course the instructor has attended. Ideally, he or she will have taken a lengthy course (be wary of the instructor trained in one weekend) with both written and practical exams. Written tests are fine for assessing a person's knowledge, but practical exams should ensure that your teacher can communicate that knowledge in a clear, well-organized manner.

It is also important that, as well as your instructor being highly qualified, you feel a good rapport with him or her. If you do, you are more likely to attend classes regularly.

>> **points to look for** in a class

- **qualified, friendly** teacher?
- **classes that suit** your level of fitness?
- **convenient class times** that fit in with your daily activities?
- **price that** suits your wallet?
- **convenient location** and parking facilities?
- **comfortable**, clean surroundings?
- **clean** floor mats?
- **good changing facilities**, showers, and secure lockers?
- **towel rental** possible?
- **drinking water** freely available?
- **somewhere to** have a snack?
- **child care** if you need it?

And finally, notice if you like the atmosphere and feel positive about the class. Does the teacher make you feel welcome? Do you get enough individual attention? You may need to try several different classes until you find the one that works best for you. You should be looking for a class that makes your dance exercise fun and energizing.